CASH TO COMPANY · STRATEGIC REFERENCE

a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

Cash & Company

MASTER · ROLLOUT & OPERATIONS

Implementation Guide

How a school, district, or family runs the year - cleanly, on calendar.

Pacing windows, materials lists, professional learning, and the operational checklist that turns curriculum docs into a working classroom.

IMPLEMENTATION GUIDE

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> Curriculum that sits on a shelf is decoration. Curriculum that runs is a program.

Audience: schools, homeschool families, micro-schools, after-school programs, and curriculum leads adopting Cash to Company K-12.

This guide answers: how do we actually run this?

1. Three implementation models

There are three common ways schools or families run Cash to Company. Pick the model that fits your scheduling reality. All three are valid; the program is built to flex.

MODEL A — STANDALONE WEEKLY COURSE

Best for: schools with a dedicated entrepreneurship/financial-literacy period or homeschool families. **Time:** 60–90 minutes/week (K-2: 30–45 min/week). **Pacing:** ~36 weeks/year. One unit per quarter. **Pros:** Most coherent; full-strand work; richest Capstone. **Cons:** Requires a dedicated period in the master schedule.

MODEL B — EMBEDDED IN ANOTHER COURSE

Best for: schools with no extra schedule space; embed in math, ELA, social studies, or CTE. **Time:** 30–45 minutes/week within the host course. **Pacing:** ~24 weeks/year (truncated). Two units per semester, abbreviated. **Pros:** Leverages existing time; cross-curricular connections explicit. **Cons:** Less time per unit; Capstones run lighter; harder to do full Cash video sequence.

MODEL C — INTENSIVE SPRINT

Best for: after-school programs, summer programs, or schools running Cash to Company as a 6–8 week intensive. **Time:** 2–3 hours/week for 6–8 weeks. **Pacing:** Pick one grade's most-essential unit (often Unit 1: customer/idea + Unit 2: pricing) and run it deep. **Pros:** Faster impact; great fit for after-school program structures. **Cons:** Doesn't build the full year's strand work; shouldn't be marketed as "the curriculum" — it's a slice.

2. Year structure (Model A — the default)

For a school running the standalone weekly course, here's the macro pattern that works:

Time	What's happening
Weeks 1–2	Course launch. Norms. Capstone topic selection.
Weeks 3–8	Unit 1 (with Cash V1). Checkpoint 1 in Week 8.
Weeks 9–18	Unit 2 (with Cash V2). Checkpoint 2 in Week 18.
Weeks 19–28	Unit 3 (with Cash V3). Checkpoint 3 in Week 28.

Time	What's happening
Weeks 29–35	Unit 4 (with Cash V4).
Week 36	Final Capstone Defense / Showcase.

The four-quarter rhythm matches most academic calendars. Each unit ends with a checkpoint that's the unit's anchor artifact, graded on a Rubric Bank rubric.

WEEKLY MICRO-PATTERN (MODEL A)

A typical week:

Day	What
Monday	5-min Cash video (or printed transcript). Capstone Journal opener. Whole-class quick share.
Wednesday	Long block (45–60 min). Mini-lesson + Capstone work + 5-min close. Teacher confers with 4–6 students.
Friday	15–20 min Showcase + Stuck. Three or four students share progress; one shares "where I'm stuck"; class generates suggestions.

Other days have brief 5–10 min vocabulary openers if you have them in the schedule.

DAILY MICRO-PATTERN (MODEL B — EMBEDDED)

In a math/ELA/SS host course:

- 5 minutes weekly: Cash video segment + journal opener.
- 15–20 minutes weekly: focused mini-lesson on the Cash to Company concept of the week.
- 15 minutes weekly: applied practice within the host course (e.g., a math word problem becomes a Cash to Company pricing problem; an ELA writing prompt becomes a Cash to Company customer interview write-up).

Build it into the existing weekly rhythm, not in addition to it.

3. Materials checklist

PER STUDENT (ONE-TIME SETUP)

- A **Capstone Journal** (composition notebook is fine; digital optional).
- The **Student Activity Book** for their grade (printed packet or digital fillable).
- Highlighters in 3 colors (yellow, blue, pink — used in Grade 6+ for transcript coding).
- Sticky notes (a small pad).
- A folder or section for accumulating artifacts (interview transcripts, drafts, posters).

PER CLASSROOM

- Wall space for Persona posters / artifact gallery.
- Access to the **8 grade-specific Cash videos** (streaming or download).
- One **Implementation Pack** with templates: persona one-pager, pricing worksheet, A/B test grid, feedback survey, sales rubric, 12-month cash flow template (high school).
- A **Rubric Bank** copy (5 rubrics).
- The **Teacher Guide** for the grade level.

OPTIONAL BUT USEFUL

- A **classroom economy** system (currency, jobs, store) for grades 2–8 — runs in parallel and reinforces the entrepreneurship work.
- Access to a **spreadsheet tool** (Google Sheets, Excel for Web, or paper) — needed at Grades 8+ for break-even and cash flow.
- A small **classroom market** budget — even $50/grade level/year — to support real product-making for Grade 5 Market Day or Grade 7 Capstones.
- A **panel of guest evaluators** for end-of-year defenses (other teachers, parents, older students, community members).

TECH REQUIREMENTS

The program is print-first by design. The minimum tech is the ability to play the 8 Cash videos for the year (or read transcripts aloud). Higher-grade work benefits from spreadsheet access but doesn't require it for the core curriculum.

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4. Assessment cadence

PER LESSON (FORMATIVE)

- Exit tickets (1-question, 1–2 sentences). Read for understanding, not grading.
- Capstone Journal entries (10–15 min). Read 1–2 per day during conferring.

PER WEEK (FORMATIVE)

- Friday Showcase + Stuck. Note who shared, who's struggling.
- One vocabulary check (Tuesday or Thursday opener; 10 terms; not graded heavily).

PER UNIT (SUMMATIVE)

- The Capstone Checkpoint — anchor artifact graded on a Rubric Bank rubric.
- A short reflection memo using the Reflection Writing rubric.

PER YEAR (SUMMATIVE)

- The Final Capstone Defense, graded on the Pitch Presentation rubric.

- The Capstone Journal portfolio, graded on the Reflection Writing rubric.
- (Optional) A 30-question vocabulary + concept check for state-reporting purposes.

REPORTING

For schools that need to report grades:

- Weight Capstone Checkpoints (4 per year) at 60% of the grade.
- Weight Final Capstone Defense at 20%.
- Weight participation/journal/vocabulary at 20%.

For schools that don't issue traditional grades, the 4 Checkpoint rubrics + Final Defense rubric give a portfolio-quality narrative for parents and counselors.

5. Cross-grade coordination

If your school adopts the program K-12 (or a multi-grade band), set aside time for:

ONCE PER YEAR — VERTICAL ALIGNMENT MEETING

Grade-level teachers across the band (e.g., K-5 elementary team, or 6-8 middle team) meet to: - Confirm who's covering which strand outcomes. - Share anchor papers across grades. - Identify gaps where students arrive without expected base.

TWICE PER YEAR — CALIBRATION SESSION

If multiple teachers grade Capstones, score 3–5 sample Capstones together using the same rubric before independent scoring. Discuss differences. Recalibrate.

END OF YEAR — HANDOFF CONVERSATIONS

Receiving teachers (next grade's) should review the Capstone Journals of arriving students before the school year starts. 30 minutes scanning ten journals tells you where the cohort is.

6. Family engagement

The Parent Guide goes home in Week 1 with a brief overview and three optional conversation starters. Beyond that:

THREE LIGHT TOUCHES PER YEAR

- **Mid-fall:** A 1-paragraph email summarizing what the unit covered. Optional question to ask at home.
- **Mid-spring:** A 1-paragraph email previewing the Final Defense and inviting interested families to attend.
- **End of year:** An invitation to the Final Defense / Showcase.

ONE BIGGER TOUCH (OPTIONAL)

- A **family showcase night** where students present their Capstone to families and community members. High-investment but high-payoff event; consider running every other year.

SENSITIVITY REMINDERS FOR FAMILY COMMUNICATIONS

- **Never imply** that families "should" be teaching financial topics at home. Many families do; some can't. Both are fine.
- **Never suggest** specific home actions that require resources (an investment account, a credit card, a savings allocation). Use language like "if your family already does this..."
- **Always provide** an opt-out for any family interview activity.

7. Homeschool / micro-school adaptations

The program is built for full-class implementation but adapts well to small groups. Key adaptations:

ONE OR TWO STUDENTS

- Skip the four-corners and gallery-walk activities; replace with conversation-based equivalents.
- Pair the student with a "customer pool" from their community (cousins, neighbors, online friends with permission). Keep the customer pool stable across the year.
- Use the Cash videos as discussion launchers with a parent or co-learner.
- Defenses can be delivered to a small panel of family friends or extended family via video call.

MULTI-GRADE FAMILY

- Run the same year theme across multiple kids' grade levels. They'll learn from each other.
- Older siblings can serve as panel members for younger siblings' defenses (a real Cash to Company tradition).
- Use Grade 11/12 students to teach Grade 5 lessons — this is built into the program's recommended differentiation.

SCHEDULE FLEXIBILITY

Homeschool families can run Cash to Company in:

- **Daily 30-minute blocks** (5 days × 30 min = 2.5 hr/week).
- **Two 60–75 minute blocks** (typical for homeschool co-ops).
- **One full-day weekly intensive** (good for project-heavy weeks).

The Capstone is the anchor; whatever schedule keeps students moving through the four units in the year is fine.

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8. After-school and out-of-school adaptations

AFTER-SCHOOL PROGRAMS (90 MIN/SESSION, 1–3X/WEEK)

- Use Model C — run a 6–8 week intensive on the highest-leverage unit for the grade band.
- For K-2: Unit on "Businesses help people" + simple classroom-store simulation.
- For 3-5: Unit on cost/revenue/profit + Market Day capstone.
- For 6-8: Unit on customer + persona + per-customer math.
- For 9-12: Unit on sales conversation + cash flow + 6-week venture sprint.

SUMMER PROGRAMS (4–6 WEEKS, FULL DAYS)

- The 6-week sprint format from Grade 11 Unit 4 adapts well.
- Pair students into 2–3 person teams and run a real or simulated venture for 6 weeks.
- End with a public "Demo Day" with community panel.

9. Common rollout pitfalls

PITFALL: TRYING TO TEACH ALL 8 STRANDS AT THE SAME DEPTH IN YEAR 1

Don't. The first year of adoption, focus on getting the four-quarter unit rhythm working at one grade level. Add depth in subsequent years. Schools that try to do everything Year 1 burn out.

PITFALL: SKIPPING THE CASH VIDEOS BECAUSE "THEY FEEL OPTIONAL"

The Cash videos are concept anchors. Skipping them removes the connective tissue between units. If you can't play them, read them aloud as the opener — but include them.

PITFALL: LETTING CAPSTONES BECOME "MAKE A POSTER"

The Capstones are evidence-based artifacts: real interviews, real math, real tests. If your students are turning in posters with cartoon mascots and zero evidence, the rubric isn't being enforced. Re-read Rubric 1 (Business Plan) and Rubric 4 (Customer Research). Both prioritize evidence over polish.

PITFALL: CHEERLEADER FEEDBACK

A teacher who says "amazing!" to every Capstone draft is undermining the program. Cash never says "amazing." Neither should the rubric or the conferring teacher. Specific feedback ("Where's the contribution margin?") beats enthusiasm every time.

PITFALL: ASKING STUDENTS ABOUT FAMILY MONEY

The most common slip in financial education. Even well-meaning prompts can wound. Re-read the differentiation guide before designing any new activity. Default to hypothetical scenarios.

PITFALL: RUNNING THE CAPSTONE AS A SHARK TANK

The Capstones are about evidence and revision, not about which kid had the most impressive idea. Coach away from the "investor" framing toward "what did you learn?" — especially in panel Q&A.

10. Year-one launch checklist

A school adopting Cash to Company at one grade level for the first time:

- [ ] Pick the grade level (often Grade 7 — high engagement, well-resourced).
- [ ] Identify the teacher.
- [ ] Schedule the year (Model A, B, or C).
- [ ] Procure or print the materials (Curriculum Book, Lesson Plans, Activity Book, Cash videos, Rubric Bank, Teacher Guide).
- [ ] Send the Parent Guide home in Week 1.
- [ ] Plan the four Capstone Checkpoints on the calendar.
- [ ] Identify panel members for the Final Defense (Week 36).
- [ ] Plan a mid-year teacher reflection (Week 18) to surface what's working and what isn't.
- [ ] Plan an end-of-year debrief and decision on Year 2 expansion.

11. Long-term vertical adoption

If your school commits to K-12 adoption over time, a sensible 3-year build:

- **Year 1:** Pilot at 1 grade level (often Grade 7). Refine based on classroom evidence.
- **Year 2:** Expand to the full middle band (6–8) + add Grade 5. Set up vertical alignment meetings.
- **Year 3:** Add K-2 + 9-12. Run cross-grade events (Grade 12 students teach Grade 5 lessons; Grade 11 panels review Grade 7 Capstones).

By Year 3, students who started in Grade 7 are now in Grade 9 and have a year of Cash to Company history. The program compounds when run vertically. The strand model (the same 8 strands every year, getting deeper) is what makes that compounding possible.

12. Ongoing program refresh

The program will need updating roughly every 2–3 years:

- **Cash videos** — animation styles age out; refresh as needed.
- **Ad set for the persuasion unit** — real ads age fast. Update annually.
- **Sample receipts and price ranges** — inflation makes 2-year-old prices feel weird. Update at the Math units in particular.

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- **Standards citations** — frameworks update. Verify Jump$tart and CEE every 2 years.

This guide and the Master Scope and Sequence change much less. The strand model and grade themes are the program's bones; the seasonal updates are skin and clothes.

One promise.

Curriculum that sits on a shelf is decoration. Curriculum that runs is a program.

Cash to Company is built so a curriculum coordinator, a foundation officer, a parent, or a teacher can pick up any one of these strategic references and meet the program at full strength on the first page.

No promise of wealth. No probing of family finances. No partisan content. One question, asked patiently for thirteen years: which people, and how do you know?

For educational and operational use. This document is informational and does not constitute financial, legal, or tax advice. Standards alignment is cited per the Cash to Company Standards Alignment Map (Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS-ETS).